

Specialty Rental Operating Benchmark

Two-page source brief | Four operating archetypes | Analysis date: July 18, 2026

SUBVERTICAL THESIS

Consumer storage, B2B storage, modular space and trench safety differ in rental duration, service intensity and capital recovery. Simple standardized assets generally support stronger margins and conversion, while modular and project-driven fleets carry greater reset or utilization risk.

METRIC	ESTIMATE	RATIONALE / EVIDENCE
Revenue growth	Consumer 4% B2B storage 5% Modular 6% Trench 6%	Rationale. Growth is rate, units on rent and fleet additions: home moves for PODS, local availability for containers, project pipelines for modular and utility work for trench. Support / caveat. Mobile Mini's 2019 Storage Solutions rental revenue grew 4.0% and yield 3.5%; Modulaire reported more units on rent and 5% revenue-per-unit growth... CONFIDENCE: MIXED BY ARCHETYPE
EBITDA margin	Consumer 33% B2B storage 40% Modular 34% Trench 33%	Rationale. Simple steel containers maximize margin. Modular adds installation; trench adds branch, engineering and hauling cost; PODS bears delivery, yards and linehaul. Support / caveat. Mobile Mini disclosed a 41.0% Storage Solutions adjusted EBITDA margin in 2019. CONFIDENCE: MIXED BY ARCHETYPE
Maintenance capex / revenue	Consumer 7% B2B storage 6% Modular 8% Trench 7%	Rationale. Containers have long lives and high residuals; PODS also sustains delivery equipment, yards and systems. Modular requires refurbishment and resets. Support / caveat. Mobile Mini assets had 30-year lives and 55% residuals. McGrath uses 18 years/50% for modular and 25 years/62.5% for storage. CONFIDENCE: MIXED BY ARCHETYPE
Post-maintenance capex conversion	Consumer 79% B2B storage 85% Modular 76% Trench 79%	Rationale. The calculation is (EBITDA minus maintenance capex) / EBITDA, before interest, tax, working capital and growth capex. Support / caveat. Every range is calculated from the report's normalized margin and maintenance-capex assumptions rather than reported free cash flow. CONFIDENCE: MIXED BY ARCHETYPE
Initial contract tenor	Consumer 1 mo B2B storage 3 mos Modular 18 mos Trench 2 mos	Rationale. Consumer moves and trench phases need flexibility; commercial containers are month-based but extend. Support / caveat. PODS markets flexible monthly use; Mobile Mini used month-based rentals; McGrath states 1-12 months for storage and 12-24 months for modular... CONFIDENCE: MIXED BY ARCHETYPE
Effective customer tenure	Consumer 8 mos B2B storage 4 yrs Modular 7 yrs Trench 5 yrs	Rationale. PODS tenure ends with the move or renovation. Commercial contractors, schools, institutions and utilities return across projects, so customer life materially exceeds any one unit's rental duration. Support / caveat. Mobile Mini served about 74,000 customers with low concentration; Modulaire serves 52,000+ customers; TPRC served 5,000+ customers. CONFIDENCE: MIXED BY COMPANY
Utilization exposure	Consumer Moderate-High B2B storage Moderate Modular Moderate Trench High	Rationale. Idle fleet earns no rent. Containers redeploy readily; modular units face installation and removal friction; trench inventory rolls off with project completion. Support / caveat. Mobile Mini's 2019 utilization was 79.1% by units and 77.9% by original cost; Modulaire reported 86% in 1Q22; McGrath's 2025 utilization was 73.0%... CONFIDENCE: MIXED BY ARCHETYPE
New-unit / customer payback	Consumer 3.5 yrs B2B storage 4.5 yrs Modular 6.0 yrs Trench 3.5 yrs	Rationale. Cash payback reserves delivery, service and maintenance. Containers and trench steel have residual value; modular costs more; PODS needs rent plus move-event profit. Support / caveat. General Finance said revenue could recover original equipment cost within four years, but the report extends cash payback after direct costs. CONFIDENCE: MIXED BY ARCHETYPE
B2B versus B2C	Consumer Mixed; B2C lean B2B storage Predominantly B2B Modular Predominantly B2B Trench Predominantly B2B	Rationale. PODS materially serves households whose event-driven demand creates shorter tenure and more acquisition cost. Support / caveat. Company disclosures identify PODS as residential and commercial; Mobile Mini's account structure was commercial; Modulaire and McGrath emphasize... CONFIDENCE: MIXED BY ARCHETYPE

Specialty Rental Operating Benchmark

Two-page source brief | Four operating archetypes | Analysis date: July 18, 2026

HOW TO READ THE UNIVERSE

Six resolved operators map to consumer storage, B2B storage, modular space and trench safety. Reliant Rental remains unresolved and is explicitly excluded from the estimates.

PODS WHAT IT DOES Delivers containers for residential and commercial moving/storage. ECONOMIC MODEL Unit: container-month plus move event; revenue is rent and logistics fees. Customers solve moves or renovations. PODS runs drivers, yards and linehaul; life-event completion causes churn. SUPPORTING EVIDENCE 2m+ long-distance moves and 7m+ deliveries. Q3 2024 sales fell 7.5%, EBITDA 24%; ranges are Low confidence.	Mobile Mini WHAT IT DOES Rented storage containers and ground-level offices to commercial users. ECONOMIC MODEL Unit: box on rent; revenue was mostly rental. Branches deliver and refurbish simple assets solving temporary jobsite needs. Projects end placements, but accounts repeat. Long lives and residuals limit capital needs. SUPPORTING EVIDENCE 2019 standalone: \$490.7m Storage revenue, 41.0% margin, 79.1% unit utilization; assets had 30-year lives and 55% residuals	Trench Plate Rental WHAT IT DOES Rented trench plates, shoring and safety systems to contractors and utilities. ECONOMIC MODEL Unit: jobsite equipment set; revenue is rental/support. Branches solve mandatory excavation safety, then inspect and redeploy steel. Projects end rentals, but contractors repeat. SUPPORTING EVIDENCE Pre-2021 merger: 37 branches and 5,000+ customers. Financial ranges are Medium-confidence triangulations.
General Finance Corporation WHAT IT DOES Rented containers, mobile offices and modular units through regional brands. ECONOMIC MODEL Unit: fleet asset; revenue is lease plus sales. Customers need temporary space. GFC delivered, maintained and re-leased units projects cause churn, while accounts repeat. SUPPORTING EVIDENCE FY2020: \$164.7m North America and \$63.1m Asia-Pacific leasing revenue; 70%-85% utilization, 20-30-year lives, residuals up to 70%.	Modulaire Group WHAT IT DOES Rents and installs modular space for public, infrastructure and enterprise users. ECONOMIC MODEL Unit: module on rent; revenue is lease/service. Customers need temporary space. Modulaire transports, installs and refurbishes units; installation and repeat projects support retention. SUPPORTING EVIDENCE 330,000 units, 52,000+ customers. 1Q22: EUR370m revenue, EUR116m EBITDA, 86% utilization; capex precision is weaker.	McGrath RentCorp WHAT IT DOES Rents modular buildings and storage containers to businesses and institutions. ECONOMIC MODEL Unit: module/container; revenue is rent plus delivery/service. Customers need classrooms, jobsite space or storage. McGrath installs and refurbishes; repeat accounts outlast placements. SUPPORTING EVIDENCE 2025: modular utilization 73.0%, storage 60.8%. Lives/residuals: modular 18 years/50%; storage 25 years/62.5%.

UNRESOLVED IDENTITY - EXCLUDED FROM ESTIMATES

Reliant Rental

No standalone specialty-rental operator is resolved; evidence points only to a Vander/BlueLine brand candidate. A 2014 trademark links Reliant to Vander; BlueLine sold in 2018. All metrics are Unavailable, Low confidence and unweighted.

KEY DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

1. Keep the four archetypes separate: asset standardization and service intensity are the largest sources of... | 2. Use gross replacement and refurbishment requirements, not depreciation or net capex alone, to assess... | 3. Track physical and dollar utilization with consistent denominators; delivery, yard and branch utilization...